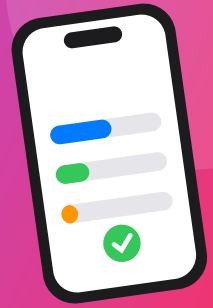


Rescue Your iPhone Storage

Squash a bloated "System Data" and keep every photo, message, and app. No new phone required.



67.85 GB

SYSTEM DATA BEFORE



37 GB

TOTAL USED AFTER

Is this you?

Settings > General > iPhone Storage says **System Data** is huge (normal is about 5-15 GB) and nothing you delete makes a dent. That's leftover clutter Settings can't touch. The fix Apple supports: back up, erase, restore. Your stuff comes back, the junk doesn't.

Pack your patience

Grab Wi-Fi, a charger, and your Apple ID password. Budget about an hour. Grab a snack while it works.

PART 1

Get ready

1

Check your iCloud space

Settings > [Your Name] > iCloud. Short on room? Rent a bigger plan for a month. It's cheap insurance.

2

Switch on iCloud Backup

Settings > [Your Name] > iCloud > iCloud Backup, then flip it on.

3

Back up right now, and check it

Tap **Back Up Now** and stay on Wi-Fi. When it finishes, 'Last successful backup' must say **today, a few minutes ago**. Don't move on until you see that.



4

Rescue anything not in iCloud

Make sure Photos are synced or exported. Note apps that keep data only on the phone (some authenticators and game saves).

PART 2

Erase (deep breath)

1

Find the big button

Settings > General > Transfer or Reset iPhone > **Erase All Content and Settings** > Continue.

2

eSIM? Pick 'Keep eSIM and Erase Data'

Your cellular plan stays put, so there's no calling the carrier later.

3

Say yes to the Find My prompt

Tap Continue and enter your Apple ID password. With AppleCare+ Theft and Loss? Relax: this pauses Find My for a bit, it does **not** cancel your coverage.

!

4

Watch it wipe

The phone restarts and greets you with a big friendly 'Hello'.

PART 3

Restore (the fun part)

1

Set up like a new phone

Pick language and region, join Wi-Fi, and let it activate.

2

Choose 'Restore from iCloud Backup'

Sign in with your Apple ID and pick the backup you just made. Check the date and time!

3

Let it cook

Stay on Wi-Fi and plugged in. Apps and photos keep downloading in the background for an hour or more, so numbers settle over time.

4

Log back in to your apps

Banking, streaming, and work apps may ask for a fresh sign-in.

Victory lap

1

Peek at Find My

Settings > [Your Name] > Find My > Find My iPhone. Toggle greyed out while **Find My network** is on? Totally normal with Stolen Device Protection. It's active and your coverage is intact.



2

Check your storage

Settings > General > iPhone Storage. Give it a few hours to recount, then enjoy the space. Ours went from a 67.85 GB System Data monster to 37 GB used in total.



Messages says 'Syncing with iCloud paused'?

Very common right after a restore. **1.** Stay on Wi-Fi and charging for 5-10 minutes. **2.** Settings > [Your Name] > iCloud > Messages: toggle off, count to 10, toggle on. **3.** Confirm your backup finished under iCloud Backup. **4.** Still paused after an hour or two? Restart the phone.

Still stuck?

If storage is still huge after everything settles, Apple Support can take a look. Now pass this along to a friend with a full phone!